

A Choice That Has a Cost: The Second Attempt

有代价的选择：第二次尝试

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The second attempt was designed **to** answer a question about **life** rather than about money: what **should** a person **feel** when the work he built is handed **to** somebody else? “He **himself shall** decide,” the director said. “She **herself shall** decide. And the **future** will **refer to** neither of them by name.”

The **behavior** of the two friends was studied by a psychologist during the whole week. “**Affect** is not **character**,” she warned. “A **circumstance** can make an honest person behave badly, and a **reform** can make a bad habit look like a **moral** choice.”

The **complex** part was the appointment of a successor. “We **retain** the **responsibility** and we **appoint** the **accountability**,” the auditor said. “The **alternative** is a **psychological** knot: **anxiety** about the **fate** of the archive and no authority over it.”

The **psychology** of the pair was **striking**. “Every **automatic click** of the mouse carries an **ethic** inside it,” Lin said. “The **ethics** of a small team are embedded in its habits, not in its rules.” A **corruption** of the process would be visible only **to** a reader with a **conscience**.

The **optional** parts of the handover were the **souvenir**, the **kite**, the **yoga** mat, and the **stormy** letter of resignation that nobody sent. “An **idealistic** plan and a **liver** complaint have the same effect on a schedule,” Maya wrote, and the joke landed because it was true.

The second attempt consisted of one page, one signature, and one rule that the friends agreed **to** obey under pressure. The age of the project was now part of its value, and the water in the well was still the same water. It was **important to** **dream** of a **secure** archive; the **evil** was not in the ambition but in the **corruption** of it. The air, the water, and the well were the same as before, and the process was the only thing under our control. These things we **never** said out loud: that we had thought about leaving, and that the win mattered less than the method. During the second year the authority to appoint was ours, and now it is not. Under it all lay a simple fact, and it was just as true the second time. We had **to** find a way into the live archive, and it was left **to us**.

中文翻译

第二次尝试的设计目的，是回答一个关于生活而不是关于钱的问题：当一个人亲手建起来的工作被交到别人手里，他应当有什么感受？“他自己来决定，”主管说，“她自己也来决定。而未来不会用名字提到他们中的任何一个。”

这两位朋友的行为被一位心理学家研究了整整一周。“情感不是品格，”她警告说，“一种处境可以让一个诚实的人行为糟糕，而一场改革可以让一个坏习惯看起来像一个道德选择。”

复杂的部分是继任者的任命。“我们保留责任，并任命可问责性，”审计员说，“替代方案是一个心理学上的结：对档案命运的焦虑，以及对它毫无权限。”

这对搭档的心理状态很醒目。“鼠标的每一次自动点击里都含有一种伦理，”林伟说，“一支小团队的伦理嵌在它的习惯里，而不在它的规则里。”流程的腐败，只有一个有良心的读者才看得见。

交接中可选的几样东西是纪念品、风筝、瑜伽垫，以及那封没人寄出的暴风雨般的辞职信。“一个理想主义的计划和一场肝病对日程有着同样的影响，”曼雅写道，而这个笑话之所以好笑，是因为它是真的。

第二次尝试由一页纸、一个签名，以及一条两位朋友同意在压力下遵守的规则构成。这个项目的年龄如今成了它价值的一部分，而井里的水仍然是同样的水。梦想一个安全的档案是重要的；恶不在那份雄心，而在它的腐坏。空气、水和井都和从前一样，而流程是我们唯一能控制的东西。有些事我们从未说出口：我们想过离开，而胜利没有方法重要。第二年的时候，任命的权力在我们手里，而现在不在。在这一切之下有一个简单的事实，而它第二次同样成立。我们必须找到进入那份活的档案的路，而这件事落在了我们身上。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
to tu: POS: prep	prep. 到, 向, 趋于; adv. 向前 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. The preposition to primarily indicates approach and arrival;; motion made in the direction of a place...
should ʃʊd POS: aux	aux. 应该, 将要 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: imp. of Shall; imp. Used as an auxiliary verb, to express a conditional or; contingent act or state, or as a...
life laɪf POS: n	n. 生活, 生命, 人生, 世事, 生物, 寿命, 一生, 生命力, 灵魂, 无期徒刑; [医] 生活, 生存, 生命, 寿命 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a characteristic state or mode of living; n. the experience of being alive; the course of human events and...
feel fi:l POS: vt	vt. 感觉, 觉得, 触摸, 以为; vi. 有知觉, 摸索, 同情; n. 感觉, 觉得, 触摸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an intuitive awareness; ; n. manual stimulation of the genital area for sexual pleasure; v. undergo an emoti...
important ɪm'pɔ:tənt POS: a	a. 重要的, 有地位的, 大量的, 显要的, 自负的; [计] 要点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of great significance or value; s. having or suggesting a consciousness of high position
himself hɪm'self POS: pron	pron. 他自己, 他亲自 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. An emphasized form of the third person masculine; pronoun; — used as a subject usually with he; as,...
shall ʃæl POS: aux	aux. 将 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. i. & auxiliary. To owe; to be under obligation for.; v. i. & auxiliary. To be obliged; must.; v. i. & auxili...
herself hə:'self POS: pron	pron. 她自己, 她亲自 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. An emphasized form of the third person feminine; pronoun; — used as a subject with she; as, she hers...
future 'fju:tʃə POS: n	n. 未来, 将来; a. 将来的, 未来的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time yet to come; n. a verb tense that expresses actions or states in the future; n. bulk commodities bo...
behavior bi'heɪvjə POS: n	n. 行为, 举止; [医] 行为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. manner of acting or controlling yourself; n. the action or reaction of something (as a machine or substance...
refer rɪ'fe: POS: vt	vt. 提交, 归诸于, 把...提交, 使求助于; vi. 提到, 涉及, 查阅, 查询, 咨询 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be relevant to; v. think of, regard, or classify under a subsuming principle or with a general group or in...
affect ə'fekt POS: vt	vt. 影响, 感动, 假装, 模仿, 爱好, 倾向于; n. 自觉感情 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the conscious subjective aspect of feeling or emotion; v. have an effect upon; v. act physically on; have an...
character 'kærəktə POS: n	n. 个性, 字符, 人物, 性质, 品格, 资格; [计] 字符 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the inherent complex of attributes that determines a persons moral and ethical actions and reactions; n. an...
responsibility rɪ'spɒnsə'bɪlɪtɪ POS: n	n. 责任, 职责, 负担, 可靠性; [化] 职责 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a form of trustworthiness; the trait of being answerable to someone for something or being responsible for...
circumstance 'sə:kəmstəns POS: n	n. 环境, 状况, 事件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a condition that accompanies or influences some event or activity; n. information that should be kept in mi...
dream dri:m POS: n	n. 梦, 空想, 愿望; v. 做梦, 想象, 梦想 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a series of mental images and emotions occurring during sleep; n. imaginative thoughts indulged in while aw...
reform rɪ'fɔ:m POS: n	n. 改革, 改正, 改造; vt. 改革, 改过, 革新, 重整; vi. 革新, 改过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a change for the better as a result of correcting abuses; n. a campaign aimed to correct abuses or malpract...
appoint ə'pɔɪnt POS: vt	vt. 任命, 指定, 下令; [法] 派, 派任, 任命 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. create and charge with a task or function; v. assign a duty, responsibility or obligation to; v. furnish
complex kəm'pleks POS: n	n. 综合体, 情结, 络合物; a. 复杂的, 组合的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a conceptual whole made up of complicated and related parts; n. a compound described in terms of the centra...
moral 'mɔrəl POS: n	n. 道德, 品行, 寓意; a. 道德的, 品性端正的, 精神上的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the significance of a story or event; a. concerned with principles of right and wrong or conforming to stan...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
retain ri'tein POS: vt	vt. 保持, 保有, 留住, 记得, 付定金聘请; [经] 保留, 留存 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. hold back within; v. allow to remain in a place or position or maintain a property or feature; v. secure and...
warn wɔ:n POS: vt	vt. 警告, 提醒, 通知; vi. 发出警告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. notify of danger, potential harm, or risk; v. admonish or counsel in terms of someone's behavior; v. ask to...
secure si'kjue POS: a	a. 无虑的, 安心的, 安全的, 可靠的, 保险的; vt. 固定, 获得, 保证, 使安全, 掩护, 招致; vi. 停止操作, 船抛锚 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. assure payment of; a. free from fear or doubt; easy in mind; a. free from danger or risk; a. not likely to fa...
alternative ɔ:l'te:nativ POS: n	n. 两者择一, 供替代的选择; a. 两者择一的, 供选择的; [计] 选择对象 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. necessitating a choice between mutually exclusive possibilities; s. pertaining to unconventional choices
psychological ,saikə'lɒdʒikəl POS: a	a. 心理学的, 精神上的, 心灵的; [法] 心理上的, 心理学的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. mental or emotional as opposed to physical in nature; a. of or relating to or determined by psychology
anxiety æŋ'zaiəti POS: n	n. 焦虑, 忧虑, 令人焦虑的事; [医] 焦虑 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (psychiatry) a relatively permanent state of worry and nervousness occurring in a variety of mental disord...
fate feit POS: n	n. 命运, 运气; vt. 注定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n an event (or a course of events) that will inevitably happen in the future; n the ultimate agency regarded a...
psychology sai'kɒlədʒi POS: n	n. 心理学, 心理状态; [医] 心理学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the science of mental life
automatic ,ɔ:tə'mætik POS: n	n. 自动手枪, 自动机械; a. 自动的, 机械的, 必然的, 无意识的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. operating with minimal human intervention; independent of external control; s. resembling the unthinking fu...
ethics 'eθiks POS: n	n. 道德规范; [医] 伦理学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the philosophical study of moral values and rules
evil 'i:vl POS: n	n. 邪恶, 不幸, 罪恶; a. 邪恶的, 不幸的, 有害的, 讨厌的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. morally objectionable behavior; n. that which causes harm or destruction or misfortune; the good is oft int...
corruption kə'rʌpʃən POS: n	n. 腐败, 堕落, 贪污; [计] 论误 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. decay of matter (as by rot or oxidation); n. moral perversion; impairment of virtue and moral principles; n. ...
click klik POS: n	n. 咔哒声, 啪嗒声; vi. 作咔哒声; vt. 使发咔哒声; [计] 单击 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. depression of a button on a computer mouse; v. make a clicking or ticking sound; v. produce a click; v. becom...
striking 'straikiŋ POS: a	a. 醒目的, 惊人的, 打击的, 罢工的; [法] 罢工的, 罢市的, 罢课的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the physical coming together of two or more things; n the act of contacting one thing with another; v deliver...
liver 'li:və POS: n	n. 肝脏, 生活者, 居民; [医] 肝 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. large and complicated reddish-brown glandular organ located in the upper right portion of the abdominal ca...
conscience 'kɒŋfəns POS: n	n. 良心; [法] 良心, 道德感, 正义感 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. motivation deriving logically from ethical or moral principles that govern a person's thoughts and actions...
accountability ə.kaunte'biliti POS: n	n. 负有责任, 可说明性; [化] 衡算计量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. responsibility to someone or for some activity
optional 'ɒpʃənl POS: a	a. 可选择的, 随意的; [化] 选购的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. possible but not necessary; left to personal choice
kite kait POS: n	n. 风筝, 箬帆, 空头支票, 骗子; vi. 象风筝一样飞, 轻快地移动, 使用空头支票; vt. 使上升, 骗钱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a bank check that has been fraudulently altered to increase its face value; n. a bank check drawn on insuff...
ethic 'eθik POS: n	n. 道德规范, 伦理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the principles of right and wrong that are accepted by an individual or a social group; n. a system of prin...
yoga 'jəuge POS: n	n. 瑜伽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. Hindu discipline aimed at training the consciousness for a state of perfect spiritual insight and tranquil...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
souvenir ˌsu:və'niə POS: n	n. 纪念品 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n something of sentimental value; n a reminder of past events
stormy 'sto:mi POS: a	a. 暴风雨的, 粗暴的, 激烈的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (especially of weather) affected or characterized by storms or commotion; s. characterized by violent emoti...
idealistic ai'diəlistik POS: a	a. 理想主义的, 唯心论的, 唯心主义的, 唯心主义者的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a of or relating to the philosophical doctrine of the reality of ideas; s of high moral or intellectual value;...